

Questions & Responses

Monster of the Week — Collaborative TTRPG Scenario

GAME2102 · Bow Valley College · Feb 2026 · Instructor: Yash | Session Keeper: Michael

Part 1: Elicit Information and Generate Buy-In

Method

The targeted questions below were developed collaboratively and answered through open in-person discussion during class. A fluid conversation proved far more effective than a structured written process. This allowed players to build on each other's ideas in real time and kept the buy-in feeling collaborative, rather than a chore. The dynamic nature of the discussion meant that detailed note-taking was difficult; engagement and responsiveness to the group took priority.

Targeted Questions & Answers

1. Why were Yahya and Oscar's siblings kidnapped?

Answer: A monster was acting on orders handed down by a "Dark Lord." The monster itself was a vehicle for someone else's agenda. This established the kidnappings as purposeful rather than random, and gave the group a larger threat to work toward beyond the immediate creature.

2. Where are the kidnapped siblings now?

Answer: This was deliberately left open — their location would be discovered through play rather than established in advance. This choice kept the investigation feeling genuine and gave players a reason to stay engaged with the unfolding story.

3. Who would want to kidnap them, and why?

Answer: A "Dark Lord," whose specific motives remained unknown to the group at this stage. Keeping the antagonist's reasons deliberately vague preserved a sense of mystery and allowed room for the story to develop organically as sessions progressed.

4. How did Yahya and Oscar know each other before the kidnapping?

Answer: They knew each other through their local town. This grounded the two central characters in a shared community and gave their cooperation a sense of pre-existing trust, rather than requiring the players to establish a reason to work together from scratch.

5. When and how would Eilian be integrated into the main story?

Answer: Eilian was planned from the outset as a secondary character whose connection to the central plot would surface as a twist toward the end of the campaign. This gave his player (Kyle) a clear arc to build toward while keeping his involvement narratively surprising for the rest of the group.

6. How would Viper fit into the group dynamic?

Answer: Viper was a late addition to the group due to a fourth student joining the class partway through planning. Rather than leaving him without a defined role, the group established him as a semi-professional informant working for Eilian. This gave him a clear place in the team structure and a reason to be present, despite the short notice of his inclusion.

Group Context

The majority of the group's story revolves around Yahya (Danish) and Oscar (Mike) as the two central characters, with Eilian (Kyle) serving as a secondary character whose significance grows over time. Viper (Ali) was added late due to a fourth student joining the class mid-process.

Two out of the four players (Danish and Ali) had no prior exposure to the concept of a roleplaying game before this assignment. This shaped the buy-in process considerably — foundational concepts that experienced players take for granted had to be introduced and explained during the same conversations where story decisions were being made. This brought about some unusual deviations during group discussions and impacted overall planning efficiency, but also produced a story that felt genuinely collaborative rather than driven by a single person's vision.